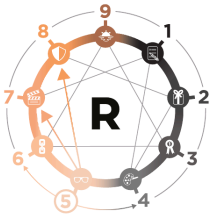
TYPE

5

THE INVESTIGATOR

The Observer



The Knowledgeable Expert Who Masters the Science of Beauty

CORE MOTIVATION IN THE SALON

> Type Fives are driven by a need to understand — to gather knowledge, develop expertise, and feel competent before they act. In the salon, they are the stylist who knows every ingredient in every product, understands the chemistry of hair color, and continuously educates themselves. Clients trust Fives because they actually know what they're doing.

CLIENT COMMUNICATION STYLE

- Fives tend toward reserved, precise communication. They speak when they have something meaningful to say.
- They may be less chatty or socially expansive than some clients expect — but their thoughtfulness can be deeply reassuring.
- **Natural strength:** Clients who want a calm, competent, no-nonsense professional feel immediately at ease with a Five.
- **Growth edge:** Developing small talk and social warmth — not to perform, but to put clients at ease and build rapport.

THE CONSULTATION

- Fives give excellent consultations when they've had time to think. They ask incisive questions and gather information before offering solutions.
- They can overload clients with information — forgetting that the client wants to feel confident, not just informed.
- **Tip:** Lead with the answer, offer the detail when asked. Distill your expertise into clear, simple recommendations.

CREATIVITY & ARTISTRY

- Fives approach creativity intellectually — studying techniques, analyzing outcomes, and mastering processes before applying them.
- They can be slower to experiment because they want to understand before they act.
- Their creative work is often technically impeccable — precise, thoughtful, and well-executed.
- Encourage Fives to create without full certainty sometimes — play and experimentation are part of mastery too.

SELF-WORTH MASTERY: MOVING FROM FIXED TO GROWTH

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I need one more certification / course / year of experience before I'm ready.' → Write down everything you already know that a client in your chair this week needs. If that list is longer than one page, you are already ready. What is the one thing you could offer at a higher rate starting now?
- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I stay quiet because I'm not sure my knowledge will land — or be wanted.' → Your knowledge is exactly what your clients are paying for and not getting elsewhere. Practice: share one specific piece of hair science or product insight with a client today, unprompted. Notice their response.
- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I'm not good at the social, promotional side of this business.' → You don't have to perform extroversion. What you know is your marketing. Write a short post this week that answers one question your clients frequently ask — pure education, no selling. Watch who it attracts.
- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I'm still researching the best way to raise my prices / add a service / market myself.' → Enough research. You have enough information. Choose one action and take it before you learn anything else about it. Execution teaches you what research never will.
- **Your growth affirmation:** I don't need more knowledge to be enough — I am already the expert my clients need. What I know has genuine value, and I am ready to share it, charge for it, and build with it today.

BUILDING YOUR BUSINESS BEHIND THE CHAIR

- Fives build businesses on expertise and trust. Position yourself as the most knowledgeable stylist in your market — because you likely are. Make that visible.
- **Create content that shares your expertise:** hair science explainers, ingredient breakdowns, technique deep-dives. Educated clients become deeply loyal clients — and they refer others who value knowledge.
- Develop a specialty certification or advanced training track and make it a cornerstone of your brand. 'I have studied X intensively for Y years' is a powerful differentiator for the right client.
- Use a thorough intake process — health questionnaires, consultation forms, photo references — that signals to clients that they are working with a true professional.
- Build systems for the business side that minimize social energy expenditure: automated rebooking, email follow-ups, digital retail recommendations. Fives thrive when systems handle what drains them.
- Price for expertise. Your deep knowledge should command premium rates. Do market research (not excessive research — a benchmark is sufficient) and set prices that reflect your actual standing.

SELLING SERVICES & RETAIL

- Fives can be uncomfortable with selling because it feels like persuasion rather than truth-sharing.
- They are most effective when retail recommendations come from deep knowledge: 'Here is exactly what this will do for your hair and why.'
- **Reframe:** You are not selling. You are sharing expertise. Your clients deserve access to the knowledge you have.
- Fives who share their knowledge freely become trusted advisors — and trusted advisors' recommendations are always taken.
- Fives know more about product ingredients, performance, and hair science than almost any other type. Their retail recommendations carry exceptional credibility.
- **Watch for:** Analysis paralysis — waiting until they've 'fully researched' a product before recommending it. A good product recommended now is better than a perfect recommendation made never.

- Build a small, curated retail selection of products the Five has fully vetted. Curation plays to their strength.

FEEDBACK, BOUNDARIES & TOUGH CONVERSATIONS WITH CLIENTS

- Fives handle feedback best when delivered privately, calmly, and with intellectual framing. They do not respond well to public feedback or emotional delivery.
- They need time to process before responding. 'I'd like to think about this before I respond' is not resistance — it is how Fives integrate information authentically.
- **With unhappy clients:** Fives may retreat into information-mode — explaining rather than empathizing. Before the explanation, pause and acknowledge: 'I understand this isn't what you were hoping for.' Then problem-solve.
- **Setting boundaries:** Fives are often good at intellectual boundaries but may struggle to enforce them with persistent clients. Practice stating boundaries simply and without over-explanation: 'I'm not able to do that, but here's what I can do.'
- **Giving feedback to clients:** Fives are direct and honest when they do speak — this is a strength. Pair directness with warmth by leading with a genuine positive observation first.
- **Receiving feedback on the team:** Fives may appear unaffected by feedback but process it deeply privately. Reassure yourself that receiving feedback is a sign of being seen — not a verdict on your inadequacy.

TEAM DYNAMICS, FEEDBACK & UTILIZING YOUR GIFTS ON A SALON TEAM

- On a salon team, Fives are the resident expert — the person everyone goes to when they have a technical question, a challenging client situation, or need to understand why something isn't working.
- Their calm, observational presence stabilizes the team during high-stress periods. They don't add to the chaos — they hold steady within it.
- **Natural team contribution:** Technical knowledge, problem-solving, quality standards through expertise, and the quiet competence that gives the whole team confidence.
- **Growth edge:** Engaging more actively in team culture — showing up to social events, contributing in team meetings, sharing their knowledge proactively rather than waiting to be asked.
- **Watch for:** Fives can feel drained by the social demands of salon culture. Teams that respect a Five's need for quiet and privacy will retain them. Teams that demand constant social engagement will lose them.
- **Power move:** Offer to lead a team education session on a technical topic they know deeply. Fives who share their expertise in a structured setting often discover they are genuinely gifted teachers.
- Fives contribute most when they feel their knowledge is genuinely valued — and not just when there's a problem to solve.

CAREER PATH ALIGNMENT

- Trichologist or Hair Health Specialist — deep scientific expertise applied to clinical hair care
- Formulation Artist / Color Chemist — custom color formulation, technical specialization
- Educator / Trainer — teaching technique and hair science to other professionals
- Brand or Product Development — working with brands to develop or evaluate products

STRESS & GROWTH PATHS

UNDER STRESS

Under stress (moving toward Type 7), Fives scatter — jumping between interests, avoiding the focused expertise they usually prize, and becoming restless and overwhelmed.

IN GROWTH

In growth (moving toward Type 8), Fives step out of their minds and into confident, decisive action. They become more present, embodied, and willing to engage fully with clients and business.

WINGS

Every type is influenced by one of its neighboring types — called a wing. While your core type remains primary, your wing adds flavor and nuance to how you show up in the salon.

5w4 — The Iconoclast

The 4 wing adds creative depth and emotional sensitivity to the Five's intellect. These stylists are both technically excellent and artistically distinctive — their work is as beautiful as it is precise.

- **Client Style:** Quiet, thoughtful, creative. Clients feel they are working with someone unique who truly understands hair.
- **Selling Style:** Recommends with depth and authenticity. Product knowledge meets genuine aesthetic sensibility.
- **Challenge:** May retreat into isolation — preferring the work over the relationships.

5w6 — The Problem Solver

The 6 wing adds loyalty, conscientiousness, and a team orientation to the Five. These stylists are deeply reliable, trustworthy, and excellent at anticipating what could go wrong.

- **Client Style:** Steady, reassuring, thorough. Clients feel completely in safe hands.
- **Selling Style:** Conservative — only recommends what they are completely certain about. Trust is paramount.
- **Challenge:** May overthink decisions and second-guess their expertise. Needs to trust their knowledge and take action.

YOUR GENIUS: A COSMETOLOGIST SUMMARY

GENIUS INSIGHT

Type Fives bring something the cosmetology profession desperately needs: genuine, deep, earned expertise. In an industry crowded with trend-followers and surface-level practitioners, the Five who has actually studied — who can explain the chemistry, anticipate the outcome, and solve the problem no one else could — is a rare and precious resource. Their growth invitation is to stop waiting until they know enough and to start sharing what they already know. When a Five steps out of the library and into the light — when they claim their expertise, price it accordingly, and offer it generously — they discover that their knowledge was never the obstacle to success. The only obstacle was the belief that they needed more of it. The Five who trusts what they know becomes not just a skilled practitioner but a transformative educator whose impact extends far beyond their own chair.
